

1. The fact that there are contingent things is contingent.
2. Every contingent fact has an explanation. (PSR)
3. The fact that there are contingent things has an explanation. (1,2)
4. The fact that there are contingent things can't be explained by any contingent thing.
5. The fact that there are contingent things is explained by some thing which is not contingent. (3,4)
6. The fact that there are contingent things is explained by some necessary thing. (5)
7. There is a necessary thing which explains the existence of contingent things. (6)
8. If there is a necessary thing which explains the existence of contingent things, then God exists.

C. God exists. (7,8)

THE COSMOLOGICAL ARGUMENT

We can again consider the hypotheses of simple theism and simple atheism, and now consider alongside them the quasi-theistic hypothesis that the universe was created by a being with the unusual property that it is literally impossible for that being not to exist.



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR

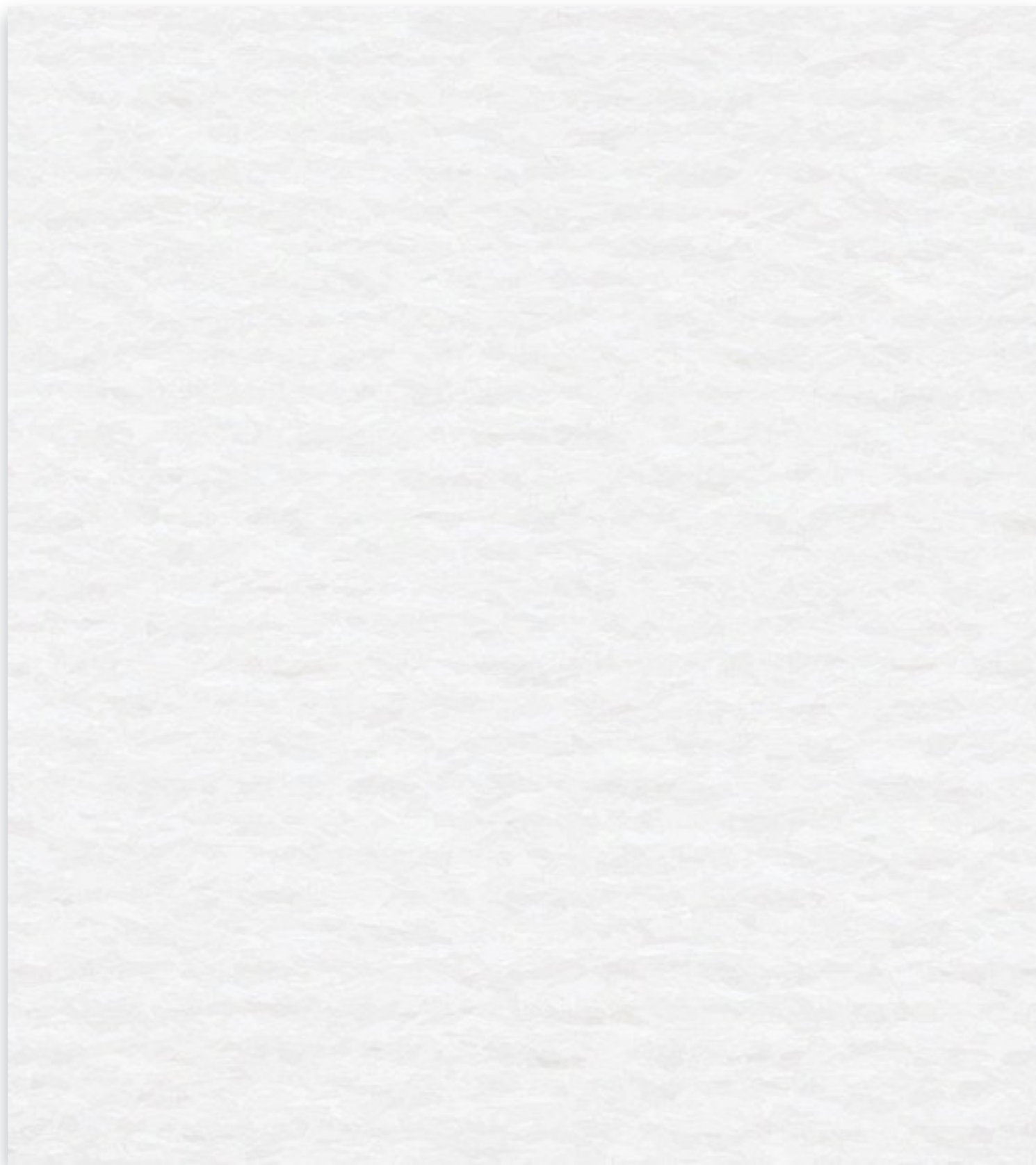


objections
to the
PSR

It is a point familiar from our discussion last time that one can always reply to an argument for the existence of God by opting for some form of quasi-theism. Such arguments are always arguments that a being with such-and-such special properties exists, and one can always concede that a being with the special properties exists, but deny that that being is God.

But, arguably, this move gets less and less plausible the more special the properties are, and the less likely it is, from an atheist's point of view, that a being with those properties would exist.

And so it is worth emphasizing that the property of existing necessarily is a very special property indeed. Everything around us seems to be contingent. A being whose existence is literally impossible would be fundamentally unlike any of the things that surround us.



1. The fact that there are no

exp1anation.(PSR)

7. There is a necessary thing which

6. The fact that there are content

2. Every contingent fact has an

4. The fact that there are content

containing it. This is.

5. The fact that there are no

things has an explanation. (1,2)

3. The fact that there are

8. If there is a necessary thing which

contingent things, then God exists.

things can't be explained by any

continuing to thrive. (6)

things is coming in.

necessary thing. (5)



explains the existence of

things is explained by some thing

explains the experience of

things is explained by some

C. Godel exists. (7, 8)

which is not consistent. $(3, 4)$



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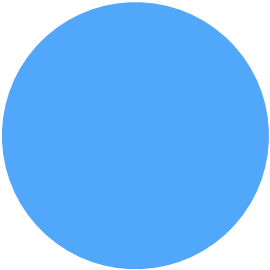
that being not to exist.

be Good.

cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could

Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first

simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to







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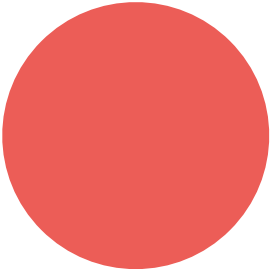


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... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.



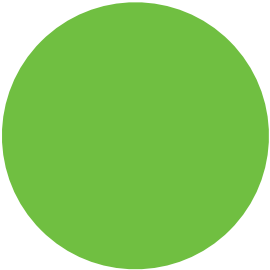
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